26900218 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEENG307 - PARTITION LITERATURE

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Find the three strategic goals that drive internal partitions identified by Brendan O'Leary. [U] / [CO1]

   a). Power, wealth and security b).Control,integration and autonomy c). Unity, peace and development d).Freedom,equality and justice

2. What is the significance of the Treaty of Lausanne (1923) in O'Leary's discussion of partition? [U] / [CO1]

   a). It reunited Germany

   b). It divided Kurdistan between Iraq and Turkey

   c). It created West and East Pakistan

   d). It partitioned Cyprus

3. which pair of fruits is mentioned in the poem "Broken Bengal"? [An] / [CO2]

a).Coconut and banana | b).Apple and orange | c).Mangoes and jackfruits | d).Grapes and guava

4. The first collection of poems by Amritha Pritam is titled as _____. [U] / [CO2]

a).Sunehade | b).Lok Peera

c).Ajj Aakhaan Waris Shah Nu | d).Amrit Lehram

5. From where does the speaker’s mother hear the cries of stranded people in the poem “Partition”? [K] / [CO2]

a).At the local marketplace b).At the border crossing

c).At her family home | d).At the Ahmedabad railway station

6. What reason does Manto give for some inmates being in the asylum despite being mentally sound? [K] / [CO3]

a). They were admitted by mistake | b). Their families couldn't afford to retrieve them | c). They were murderers whose families obtained asylum placement to spare them execution | d). They were political prisoners

7. What does Salim Mirza in *Garm Hawa* initially decide to do regarding the migration question? [U] / [CO3]

a). Definitely migrate to Pakistan | b). Move to a different city in India | c). Remain in India despite internal conflict | d). Migrate temporarily

8. Bishan Singh's refusal to accept that his hometown, Toba Tek Singh, is now in Pakistan reflects which central thematic concern of the story? [U] / [CO3]

a). The unreliability of official government records | b). The tension between abstract national boundaries and lived, embodied attachment to place | c). The failure of the postal system after Partition | d). The generational conflict between old and young inmates

9. Identify the village that forms the central setting of Train to Pakistan. [K] / [CO4]

a). Mano Majra | b). Chundunnugger

c). Amritsar | d). Lahore

10. State the religious community to which Nooran belongs in Train to Pakistan. [K] / [CO4]

a). Sikh b). Hindu

c). Muslim d). Christian

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Answer

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

11. Describe how Ayesha's past as Veero is revealed in Sabiha Sumar's Silent Waters and explain its significance. [U] / [CO1]
12. Explain why Sunderlal's idealization of Lajo as a goddess becomes problematic. [U] / [CO1]
13. Explain the significance of police firing in conveying the central concern of the poem "Karachi". [An] / [CO2]
14. Examine the significance of the image of the entombed minaret in the poem "The Country Without a Post Office". [An] / [CO2]
15. Interpret the significance of Garm Hawa's refusal to provide easy comfort or resolution. What does the ending reveal about the relationship between personal experience, historical trauma, and hope? [U] / [CO3]
16. Explain the role of religious or biological identity in the process of Partition as described in "Pali". [U] / [CO3]
17. Discuss Bhisham Sahni's use of simple and realistic language to portray complex social issues. [U] / [CO3]
18. Explain the significance of Iqbal's arrest in the novel. [A] / [CO4]
19. Briefly describe the arbitrary nature of communal boundaries in relation to Train to Pakistan. [K] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **15** marks

20. Discuss the significance of feminist interventions in recovering the silenced experiences of Partition. [U] / [CO1]
21. Analyse the function of spatial movement in the poem "Broken Bengal". How does the continuous movement from one place to another reinforce the idea of displacement? [An] / [CO2]
22. "Toba Tek Singh" is deeply rooted in the specific history of the Partition, yet the story has resonated far beyond that moment and context. Discuss Manto's [U] / [CO3]

achievement in creating a story that is simultaneously a historical document and a universal meditation on borders, displacement, and belonging.

23. How does Khushwant Singh portray displacement in The Train to Pakistan? [A] / [CO4]

[15x2 = 30]